SOHAIL RAZA

PhD Candidate in Finance, Deakin University

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Research Interests

Fields Empirical Corporate Finance; Behavioural Corporate Finance

Topics Climate Risk; Mergers & Acquisitions; Institutional Ownership; Corporate Innovation; Corporate Governance; Corporate Political Activity

Education

Deakin University 2023–Present
PhD in Finance (thesis under examination) *Melbourne, Australia*
Thesis: Three Essays on Corporate Adaptation to Climate Risk, Responsible Ownership, and Political Influence

Xiamen University 2017–2019
Master of Economics in Finance *Xiamen, China*

Aligarh Muslim University 2014–2016
M.A. in Economics *Aligarh, India*

Aligarh Muslim University 2011–2014
B.A. (Honours) in Economics *Aligarh, India*

Research

Job Market Paper

Climate Change Exposure and Acquisitions of Green Assets: Evidence from the Market for Corporate Control
with Saikat S. Deb, Edward J. Podolski, and Wei Shi
Resubmission invited, Journal of Banking & Finance (September 2026)
[SSRN]

Working Papers

Socially Responsible Institutional Ownership and the Direction of Green Innovation
with Saikat S. Deb, Edward J. Podolski, and Wei Shi

Corporate Lobbying and Investment Efficiency
with Saikat S. Deb, Edward J. Podolski, and Wei Shi
Accepted for presentation, FMA Asia-Pacific Conference 2026

Publications

1. **Raza, S.**, & Munir, S. (2023). The impact of U.S. quantitative easing (QE) announcements on Indian government bond yields. *Asian Journal of Economics, Business and Accounting*, 23(19), 179–206.
2. Munir, S., **Raza, S.**, & Haq, K. A. (2023). Critical value functions for likelihood-ratio tests under normality. *Chilean Journal of Statistics*, 14(1).

Research Resource

Green Business Activity Dictionary [GitHub]
Keyword dictionary for identifying green business activities in corporate disclosures and business descriptions, built from environmental taxonomies, climate-transition frameworks, industry classifications, and the climate-finance literature.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Conferences

New Zealand Finance Meeting 14–16 Dec 2026
Auckland University of Technology, Auckland, New Zealand
Accepted: *Climate Change Exposure and Green Acquisitions: Evidence from the Market for Corporate Control*

FMA Asia-Pacific Conference 2–4 Dec 2026
Massey University, New Zealand
Accepted: *Corporate Lobbying and Investment Efficiency* (main session); Discussant, Firm Innovation session

FIRN Corporate Finance Research Meeting 1–2 Oct 2026
Adelaide University, Adelaide, Australia
Climate Change Exposure and Green Acquisitions: Evidence from the Market for Corporate Control (presented by co-author)

Macquarie Business School Accounting and Finance Conference 9–10 Jul 2026
Macquarie University, Sydney, Australia
Climate Change Exposure and Acquisitions of Green Assets: Evidence from the Market for Corporate Control

FMA Asia-Pacific Conference 15–17 Dec 2025
National Taiwan University, Taipei, Taiwan
Climate Risk and Strategic M&A (main session); Discussant, Corporate ESG session

Workshops, Seminars and Summer Schools

4th PhD Summer Institute in International Trade & Industrial Organisation Mar 2026
Deakin University, Melbourne, Australia
Climate Risk and Strategic M&A

Deakin Brown Bag Seminar 2025
Deakin University, Melbourne, Australia
Climate Risk and Strategic M&A

I.S.E.O. Summer School (PhD) 14–21 Jun 2025
Iseo, Italy
Poster: *Climate Risk and Strategic M&A*

Teaching and Academic Appointments

Deakin University Oct 2026–Dec 2026
Casual Research Assistant, Department of Accounting *Melbourne, Australia*

- Developing text-based algorithms in RStudio to extract workplace gender equality indicators and related information from firms' annual reports.
- Validating the extracted information against actual data and creating the resulting dataset.

RMIT University 2025–Present
Casual Academic / Research Fellow
BAFI3257 Corporate Financial Management; BAFI1005 Financial Markets and Institutions; BAFI1018 International Finance; BAFI1042 Equity Investment and Portfolio Management; BAFI3276 Applied Finance: A Case Study Approach; ACCT1060 Managerial Advisory Finance

Deakin University 2023–Present
Graduate Researcher; Graduate Research Teaching Fellow / Casual Academic
MAF302 Corporate Finance; MAF202 Money and Capital Markets; MAF307 Equities and Investment Analysis; MAF308 Financial Derivatives and Risk Management; MIS770 Foundation Skills in Data Analysis

Deakin College 2024–Jul 2026
Academic Teacher, Diploma of Commerce
MAF101 Fundamentals of Finance; MAA104 Financial Literacy; MAE101 Economic Principles; MAE120 Money, Growth and the Economy

Xiamen University 2019–2020
Teaching Assistant
Literature Review and Thesis Writing

Awards and Scholarships

DUPR Scholarship, Deakin Business School, Deakin University 2023
Excellent Student Award (2nd Prize), Xiamen University 2019
Chinese Government Scholarship 2017, 2019
Paper Presentation Award, ICSSR, Aligarh Muslim University 2015

Professional Service

Ad hoc referee, *Australian Journal of Management* 2025–Present
Discussant, FMA Asia-Pacific Conference 2025, 2026

Other Professional Experience

OW DataLeads Oct 2022–Jan 2023
Research and Data Training Associate *India*

- Sourced and compiled South Asian health data for the *Kruxd* global health database.
- Supported Google News Initiative training for Indian media organisations on political datasets and data tools (Tabula, Flourish).

Paperpedia Pvt. Ltd. Jun 2021–Apr 2022
Academic Research Writer *India*

- Sourced macro- and micro-level data from WRDS, IPUMS, and ISS.
- Conducted empirical analysis in Stata, R, and Excel for economics, finance, and statistics projects.

Data and Computing Skills

Databases	WRDS (CRSP, Compustat, I/B/E/S, BoardEx, ISS Voting Analytics); Refinitiv Workspace (ESG, SDC Platinum); Thomson Reuters 13-F; USPTO and KPSS patent data; FINRA; SIRCA
Climate data	NOAA Climate Data Online; NASA GISS Surface Temperature Analysis; EPA plant-level toxic emissions
Corporate Filings	10-K, 8-K, 425, and S-4
Methods	Web scraping using API; dictionary-based textual analysis; spatial visualization
Software	Stata; RStudio; VS Code; Power BI; Flourish; LaTeX

References

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Senior Lecturer in Finance
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Dr Wei Shi
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